



Bifurcation of teams: Bengal captain Anustup Majumdar believes that the growing pool of talent has enabled State teams to develop separate squads for red-ball and white-ball formats. RITU RAJ KONWAR

To mitigate weather disruptions, the BCCI has split the Ranji Trophy into two phases. The tournament will start with five league matches, take a break for the white-ball

competitions — Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy and Vijay Hazare Trophy — and then resume.

In this scenario, having two separate setups could be beneficial. In fact, Assam Cricket Association has taken the lead by appointing two different coaches. While Vivek Jaisimha will oversee the red-ball tournament, RX Murali will manage the white-ball sides. If this experiment proves successful, other states may follow suit.

But how challenging will it be for teams to switch formats with minimal turnaround time?

“It’s all about the mental switch because it’s not easy to shift to white-ball cricket after playing red-ball for a couple of months, and then switch again within a month. It’ll be interesting to see how players respond to this challenge,” says P.V. Shashikanth, former head coach of Karnataka and currently with Tripura.